

MARIE SKLODOWSKA CURIE

+33 1 40 46 75 00 – marie.curie@sorbonne.fr – Paris, France – [Nobel Prize Profile](#)

EDUCATION

Doctor of Science in Physics Awarded 'tres honorable' (very honorable) <i>University of Paris (Sorbonne)</i> - Thesis established the new scientific field of radioactivity, hypothesizing that radiation was an atomic property. - Presented novel methodologies for the measurement of radioactivity, forming a cornerstone for future research in atomic physics.	Paris, FR Jun 1903
Degree in Mathematics Graduated second in class <i>University of Paris (Sorbonne)</i> - Acquired advanced mathematical knowledge essential for theoretical physics and quantitative modeling. - Pursued as a second degree to build a multidisciplinary foundation for scientific research.	Paris, FR Jul 1894
Degree in Physics Graduated first in class <i>University of Paris (Sorbonne)</i> - Achieved top academic standing in a rigorous curriculum covering mechanics, electricity, and thermodynamics. - Built a comprehensive understanding of classical physics, enabling the identification of phenomena that defied existing theories.	Paris, FR Jul 1893
Informal Scientific Training Completed Clandestine Studies <i>Flying University (Uniwersytet Latajacy)</i> - Participated in a clandestine underground university to pursue scientific education forbidden to women in Poland. - Gained foundational knowledge in chemistry and physics, sparking an interest in empirical research.	Warsaw, PL 1886 - 1889

EXPERIENCE

Director of the Radium Institute <i>at University of Paris</i> - Held the post of Professor of General Physics, succeeding Pierre Curie and becoming the first female professor at the Sorbonne (appointed 1906). - Directed a world-leading research center for chemistry, physics, and medicine, mentoring numerous doctoral students. - Established a new scientific discipline and oversaw fundamental research into the nature of radioactivity and its applications.	Paris, FR 1914 - 1934
Director of the Red Cross Radiology Service <i>at French Red Cross</i> - Conceptualized and developed mobile radiography units ('petites Curies') to diagnose injuries at the front lines. - Authored training materials and personally instructed 150 women as the first military radiology technicians.	France 1914 - 1918
Researcher & Scientist <i>at School of Chemistry and Physics (ESPCI)</i> - Conducted foundational research on 'Becquerel rays', coining the term 'radioactivity'. - Discovered and scientifically described two new elements in the periodic table: polonium (Po, 1898) and radium (Ra, 1898). - Determined the atomic weight of radium, solidifying its status as a new element, and investigated its physical and chemical properties.	Paris, FR 1897 - 1906

SKILLS

Scientific Expertise: Radioactivity, Nuclear Physics (emerging), Analytical Chemistry, Crystallography, Electrometry
Laboratory Techniques: Fractional Crystallization, Chemical Separation & Isolation, Electrometric Measurement, Radiography (X-ray), Glassblowing, Sample Preparation
Technical Instrumentation: Piezoelectric Electrometer, Mobile X-ray Units ('petites Curies'), Radiation Shielding Protocols, Calorimeters for heat measurement
Languages: Native in Polish, Fluent in French, Proficient in German & Russian, Reading knowledge of English

Scientific Leadership & Outreach

- Active participant and only female member of the prestigious Solvay Conferences on Physics and Chemistry 1911 - 1933
- Founded and directed the Radium Institute in her native Warsaw (now the Maria Skłodowska-Curie National Research Institute of Oncology) 1925 - 1932
- Maintained extensive correspondence on theoretical and experimental physics with leading scientists, including Albert Einstein, Ernest Rutherford, and Max Planck c. 1900 - 1934

Hobbies & Personal Interests

- Enjoyed long bicycle trips and extensive travel, including tours of the United States to fund her research Lifelong
- Kept meticulous and detailed personal and scientific journals throughout her life c. 1885 - 1934
- Swimming and hiking in the mountains Lifelong